

Overview

Even if you win the Rat Race, you are still a rat.
— **Lily Tomlin**

Wikipedia defines a rat race as follows:

"*Rat race* is a term used for an endless, self-defeating or pointless pursuit. It conjures up the image of the futile efforts of a lab rat trying to escape while running around a maze or in a wheel. In an analogy to the modern city, many rats in a single maze expend a lot of effort running around, but ultimately achieve nothing (meaningful) either collectively or individually."

How many of us can relate to this? Well, I for sure was one. There are definitely many more like me who can relate to this continuous running and achieving nothing meaningful in the end.

You are well paid and have a good lifestyle. But can you afford to stop working? If your answer is 'No', then you are barely financially stable⁵ and far from being financially independent or financially free.

Believe me, you are not the only one. Most people – more than 99% of the working class retire without being financially independent. They are in a vicious cycle – the *rat race* as it is commonly called. They never have enough money to retire. Even after retirement, they are struggling to make